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Assignment: Introduction to Management Week 04

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Question 01 Explain the systematic decision making process in management and discuss its major stages from problem identification to monitoring and evaluation How does each stage contribute to effective managerial decision making

Systematic Decision Making Process in Management The systematic decision making process is a step by step approach that managers use to choose the best solution among different options It helps managers make logical and well thought out choices instead of relying on pure guesswork

Major Stages of Decision Making and Their Contribution

1 Problem Identification This stage involves recognizing that a problem exists or that an opportunity is present Managers gather information to understand the root cause of the issue Contribution: It ensures that managers solve the real underlying issue rather than treating superficial symptoms

2 Identification of Decision Criteria Managers decide what factors are important for making the choice such as cost time safety quality and required resources Contribution: It sets clear standards and priorities for evaluating options objectively

3 Allocation of Weights to Criteria Not all factors carry equal importance Managers assign weight or priority to each criterion based on its significance to the organization Contribution: It helps make balanced choices by focusing on high priority goals

4 Development of Alternatives Managers brainstorm and list all possible solutions or courses of action without immediately judging them Contribution: It encourages creativity and ensures that viable options are not overlooked

5 Analysis of Alternatives Each alternative is critically evaluated against the weighted criteria to see its strengths weaknesses costs and potential outcomes Contribution: It provides an evidence based comparison of options to identify the most effective choice

6 Selection of the Best Alternative The manager chooses the option that scored highest in the evaluation process and aligns best with organizational goals Contribution: It commits the organization to a clear and logical path forward

7 Implementation of the Decision The chosen decision is put into action by assigning tasks allocating resources and communicating clearly to the team Contribution: It translates plans into real world actions and creates operational results

8 Monitoring and Evaluation Managers track the results of the decision to see if it solved the problem effectively If the outcome is not satisfactory adjustments are made Contribution: It ensures accountability allows for continuous improvement and prevents long term failures

Question 02 Differentiate between Programmed and Non-Programmed Decisions and discuss the major quantitative qualitative and strategic tools used by managers to improve the quality of decision making

Difference Between Programmed and Non-Programmed Decisions

Programmed Decisions Programmed decisions are routine repetitive and structured choices made for everyday operational issues Managers follow established policies rules and standard operating procedures to handle them Examples include processing routine leave requests reordering office supplies or handling customer returns

Non-Programmed Decisions Non-Programmed decisions are unique unstructured and complex choices made for unusual or non routine problems They require fresh judgment critical thinking and problem solving skills because no set rules exist Examples include launching a new product line expanding into foreign markets or restructuring a company

Tools Used to Improve Decision Making Quality

1 Quantitative Tools Quantitative tools rely on mathematical models statistical data and numerical analysis to guide decisions Decision Trees: Graphical diagrams that map out different options potential costs and expected monetary value Linear Programming: Mathematical techniques used to optimize resource allocation like minimizing costs or maximizing output Payoff Matrices: Tables that show expected outcomes under various future conditions to help make risk balanced decisions

2 Qualitative Tools Qualitative tools rely on human experience expert opinion teamwork and creative thinking Brainstorming: Group sessions held to generate a large number of creative ideas without immediate judgment Delphi Technique: Gathering feedback from a panel of independent experts anonymously through rounds of questionnaires until consensus is reached Nominal Group Technique: Structured team meetings where members write down ideas individually discuss them and then vote silently to prioritize options

3 Strategic Tools Strategic tools help managers align decisions with long term organizational direction and external environment SWOT Analysis: Evaluating internal Strengths and Weaknesses along with external Opportunities and Threats PESTLE Analysis: Examining Political Economic Social Technological Legal and Environmental

factors affecting the business Scenario Planning: Creating detailed descriptions of plausible future environments to prepare flexible business strategies